

Certyfikat PMP: Professional Project Closure

Balancing Administrative Precision
with Ethical Integrity

dr Zbigniew Galar

Professional Project Closure

Administrative Completeness

Closing Procurements
& Contracts

Final Product
Verification &
Acceptance

Archiving Historical
Records & Files

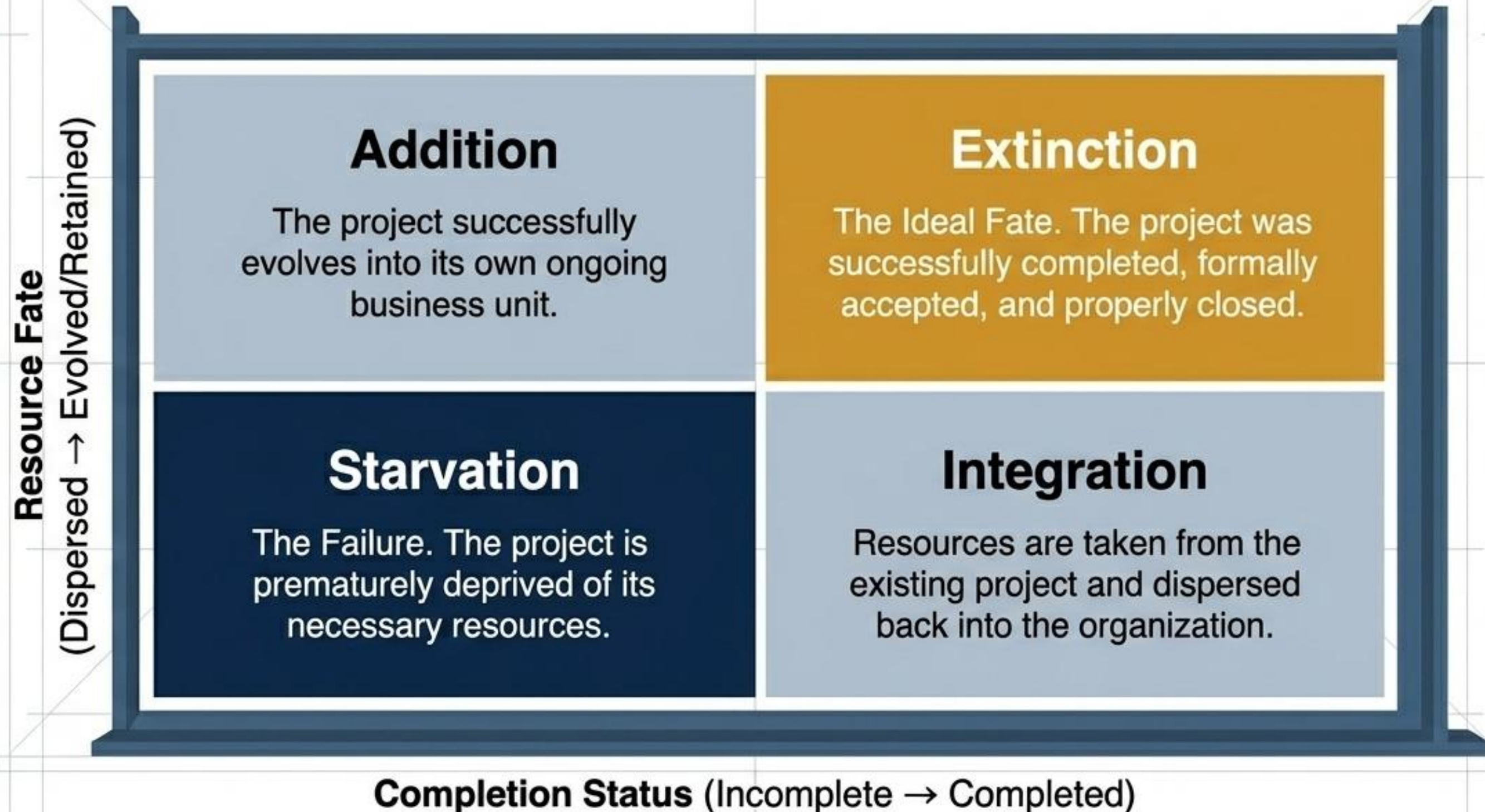
Ethical Integrity

Adhering to PMI®
Code of Ethics

Maintaining
Absolute Honesty

Avoiding Conflicts
of Interest

The 4 Destinies of a Project



The Closing Process Group

Close Project or Phase 	
Timing:	
Performed at the end of each phase and the final project.	
Focus:	
Analyzing PM process effectiveness, documenting lessons learned, archiving project documents, and confirming formal product acceptance to ensure exit criteria are met.	

Close Procurements	
Timing:	
Performed to settle and complete external contracts according to terms.	
Focus:	
Generating the contract file, performing final product verification from vendors, and issuing formal acceptance and closure.	

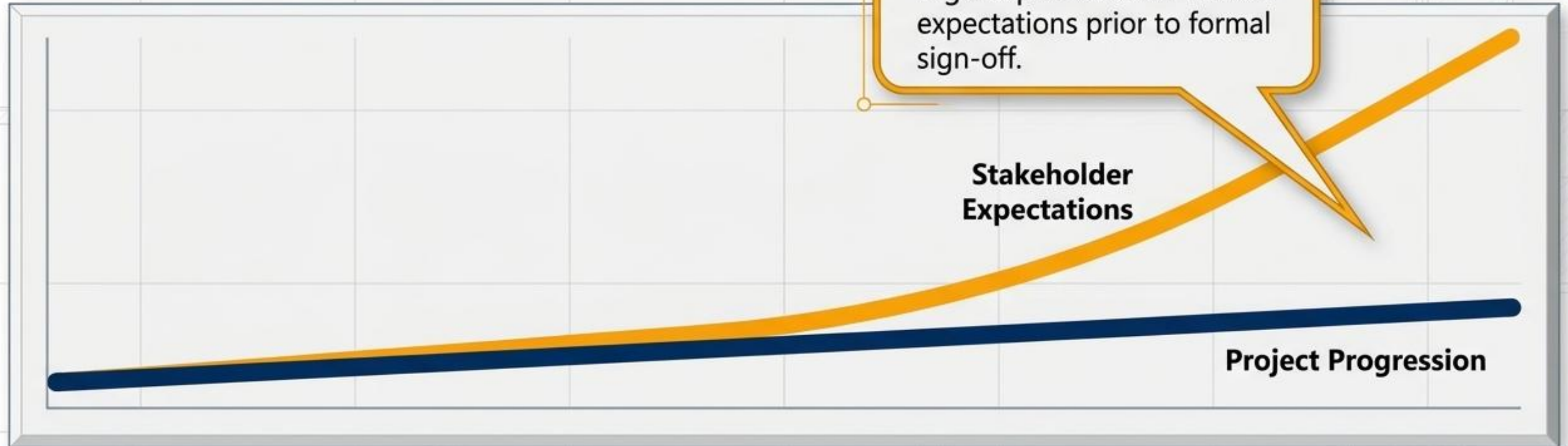
The Anatomy of Phase/Project Closure



The Expectation vs. Reality Gap

The Gap:

Dig deep to uncover hidden expectations prior to formal sign-off.



The Phenomenon

Stakeholder expectations tend to stray midway through the project as they begin to see nearly completed deliverables and imagine new possibilities.

The Metaphor

Buying a new house based on blueprints and then going on that first walk-through... "Gee, I thought that closet was bigger."

The Ethical Dimension: PMI® Code of Conduct



Conflict of Interest Diagnostic



Real World
Scenario

Scenario	The Risk	Professional Response
1. Associations: A family member (e.g., brother-in-law) bids on an RFP.	1. Undue influence or perception of bias.	1. Inform stakeholders and remove yourself from the selection committee.
2. Vendor Gifts: A vendor offers an all-expenses golf trip.	2. Exceeding organizational gift limits and compromising objectivity.	2. Decline the gift; verify and adhere strictly to company policy.
3. Stakeholder Influence: Powerful stakeholders offer rewards to bypass processes.	3. Personal interests superseding project objectives.	3. Prioritize the project outcomes; never leverage influence for personal gain.

The Imperative of Honesty

DON'T

Personal Gain

Never stretch a project timeline just to secure a personal billing bonus. Personal gain must never factor into project decisions.

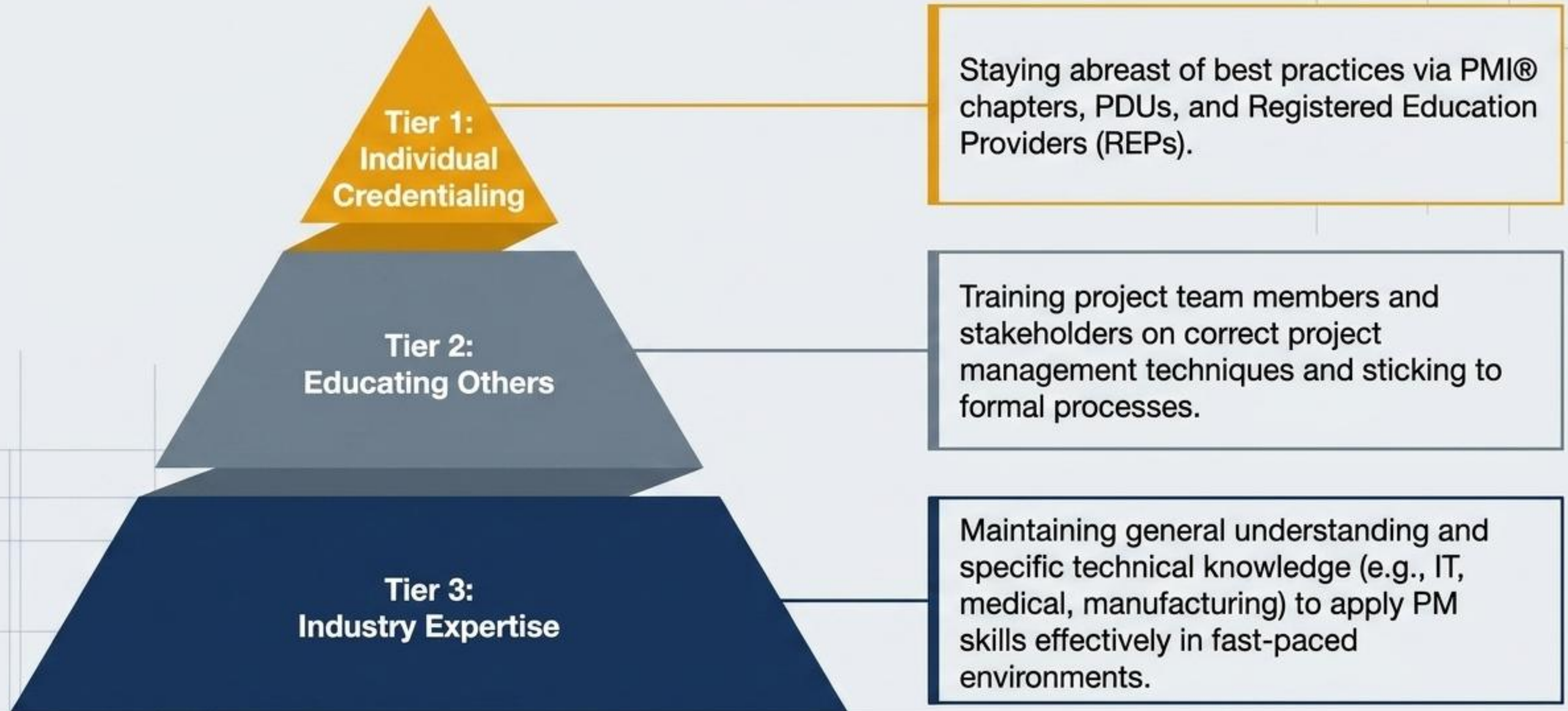
DO

Truthful Reporting

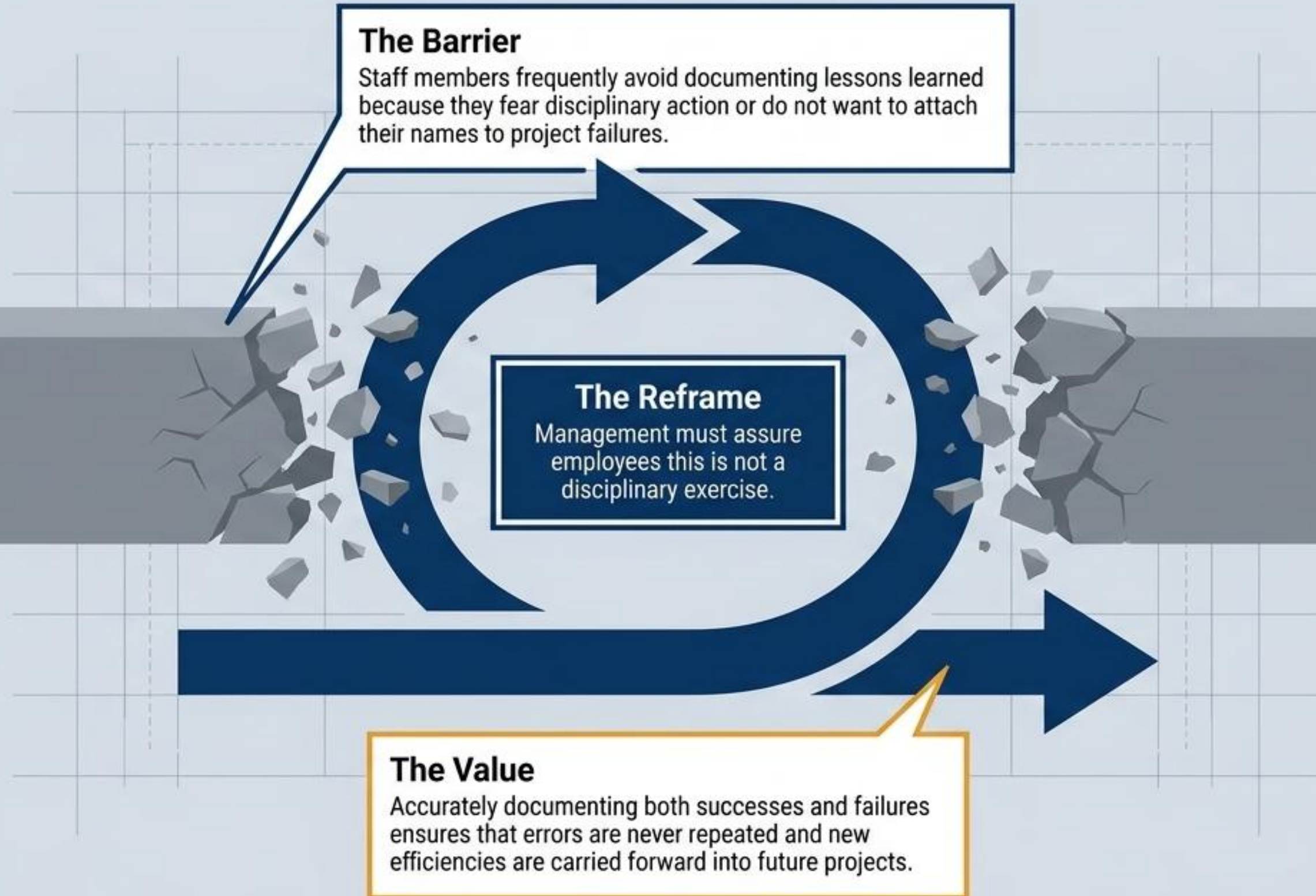
Always tell the truth regarding project status, even if the project is failing or facing unknown risks.

If the call needs to be made to kill the project, make it. Do not withhold information from oversight boards.

Applying Professional Knowledge



The Engine of Continuous Improvement: Lessons Learned





Real-World Synthesis: The Kitchen Heaven Case

Observed Action

1. Jake verified all construction work was completed correctly.
2. Creating a document of project successes and equipment shipping delays.
3. Publishing the email to Dirk and stakeholders.
4. The previous PM accepted a resort trip and revealed company secrets.

PMP® Principle Map

Product Verification (Close Procurements).

Documenting Lessons Learned.

Disseminating Formal Acceptance Notice.

Severe Ethics Violation (Conflict of Interest & Intellectual Property Breach).

The Final Audit Checklist

Process & Procurements

- ☐ Verify product correctness.
- ☐ Collect project documents.
- ☐ Disseminate final acceptance notice.
- ☐ Document lessons learned.
- ☐ Archive project records.
- ☐ Formally close contracts.

Ethics & Conduct

- ☐ Ensure personal/professional integrity.
- ☐ Subordinate personal gain to business needs.
- ☐ Avoid all conflicts of interest.
- ☐ Report questionable situations truthfully.
- ☐ Protect intellectual property.

PMP® Exam Essentials

Timing of Closure

Q: When is Close Project performed?

A: At the close of each phase AND at the close of the overall project.

Lessons Learned

Q: What is the primary purpose?

A: To describe project successes and failures to inform and improve future projects.

Customer Satisfaction

Q: What is the key activity to ensure it?

A: Accurately documenting project requirements and explicitly meeting them.

Multinational Projects

Q: How should relationships be managed?

A: By building mutual trust and respecting diverse cultural and ethnic beliefs (avoiding culture shock).

“There’s no substitute for integrity and honesty when conducting your projects. Actions speak louder than words.”

True professional closure is achieved when a project manager leaves behind not just archived documents, but a fully intact professional reputation. Lead by example.